Retell: The First Peacock

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Student A retells steps 1–4, student B steps 5–8. Then swap the roles.

In the book
4000 Essential English Words 1, Unit 10, **"The First Peacock"**, page 66 (the story) · page 67 (questions).
Read it once (5 minutes), close the book, then retell with the map below.

#	Say	Words to use
1	Where did Argos live? What was special about him?	Ancient Greece · proud father · 100 eyes
2	How did he sleep?	rest · few eyes · benefit · chance
3	Who did he work for? What was his job?	Hera · guard · cow · primary · essential
4	What was easy about his job?	grass · alone · separate
5	What did Zeus want?	take · plan · music player
6	What happened to Argos?	immediate effect · focus · fall asleep · cow gone
7	What did Hera do?	angry · peacock · eyes on the tail
8	How did the story end?	Zeus · trouble · stars · remain · sky · site

★ Ask and answer: present perfect or past simple? (add to your retelling)

1. Has Argos ever been a guard before? How long has he guarded the cow? (100 eyes · rest a few)
2. Has Zeus got the cow yet? What has happened to Argos? (music · asleep)
3. Have you ever seen a peacock? When did you see it? (park · zoo · tail)

Three ways to retell

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Rounds 1 to 3 take about 15 minutes. Then the speaking questions.

1 Round 1: with the story map

Retell the whole story to your partner. The listener ticks the words they hear.

- [ ] benefit
- [ ] certain
- [ ] chance
- [ ] effect
- [ ] essential
- [ ] far
- [ ] focus
- [ ] function
- [ ] grass
- [ ] guard
- [ ] image
- [ ] immediate
- [ ] primary
- [ ] proud
- [ ] remain
- [ ] rest
- [ ] separate
- [ ] site
- [ ] tail
- [ ] trouble

2 Round 2: change the narrator

Retell it as **Argos**, **Hera** or **Zeus**. Use "I": *"I have a hundred eyes, and I never sleep with all of them..."*

3 Round 3: change the ending

Argos does not fall asleep. What does Zeus do? Invent a new ending (3–4 sentences).

4 Listener's check

- [ ] 5+ Unit 10 words
- [ ] present perfect in the questions, past simple in the story
- [ ] a clear order
- [ ] one new idea

5 Warm-up: irregular verbs, the 3rd form, set 4 (say the 3rd form)

become	buy	catch	feel
find	get	have	hear
keep	leave		

become · bought · caught · felt · found · got (gotten) · had · heard · kept · left